

# Gabriel / Chosen

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## CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

**SCENE 3 — Mary (Jordyn), Talia (Tasha), Shira(Tyfany), Adina(Jeovanie), Dafna(Ashley)**

### CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 2

*Joseph has just exited.*

#### JOSEPH

Tomorrow?

#### MARY

Tomorrow.

*Joseph disappears.*

*Mary remains alone.*

*For several seconds, nothing happens.*

*Let the audience stay with her happiness.*

*Mary looks toward the place Joseph exited.*

*She smiles.*

*She begins quietly putting things in order.*

*Perhaps she*

*folds a piece of cloth;*

*straightens the unfinished table piece Joseph showed her;*

*moves one of the chairs;*

*touches the wood and imagines the future they were just discussing.*

*She catches herself smiling.*

#### MARY

Eight chairs.

*She shakes her head.*

#### MARY

Joseph...

*Small laugh.*

*She resumes folding.*

## THE INTERRUPTION

*The distant sounds of Nazareth are still present.*

*A voice.*

*A cart.*

*A child somewhere outside.*

*A faint hammer.*

*Then—*

*everything stops.*

*Not slowly.*

*Gone.*

*Mary notices.*

*She waits.*

### MARY

Hello?

*Nothing.*

*She listens.*

### MARY

Is someone there?

*A subtle musical texture enters.*

*Something completely different from the musical language of Nazareth.*

*Not loud.*

*Not threatening.*

*Unfamiliar.*

*The light begins changing.*

*Mary turns.*

*She sees GABRIEL.*

*Gabriel does not rush toward her.*

*Stillness is part of the power of the moment.*

### GABRIEL

Mary.

*Mary steps backward.*

### MARY

Who are you?

**GABRIEL**

Do not be afraid.

**MARY**

I wasn't—

*She stops.*

**MARY**

I... ok, wait...

*Mary stops and backs away*

*Gabriel remains calm.*

**GABRIEL**

You have found favor with God.

*Gabriel walks towards Mary*

**MARY**

Favor?

*Still walks away from Gabriel slowly*

**GABRIEL**

Yes.

*Continues walking towards Mary*

**MARY**

I don't understand.

*Still walks backwards away from Gabriel*

**GABRIEL**

You will.

*Continues walking towards Mary*

*Beat.*

**MARY**

Who are you?

*Still walks backwards away from Gabriel*

**GABRIEL**

Gabriel.

*A beat.*

*Stops walking and stands still*

**GABRIEL**

I have been sent by God.

*Mary stops, she absorbs that.*

*She looks toward the doorway, as though part of her still expects someone else to walk in and make this ordinary again.*

*No one does.*

## **THE CALLING**

**GABRIEL**

Mary...

you have been chosen.

*Mary looks at him.*

**MARY**

Chosen for what?

**GABRIEL**

You will bear a son.

*Silence.*

*Mary does not respond.*

**MARY**

I'm sorry—

what did you say?

**GABRIEL**

You will bear a son.

**MARY**

No.

*Not rejection.*

*Her mind simply cannot make the words fit.*

**MARY**

I mean—

how?

*Beat.*

**MARY**

How can that be?

**GABRIEL**

What will happen comes from God.

**MARY**

I understand the words.

*Beat.*

**MARY**

I don't understand how they can be true.

**GABRIEL**

Nothing God has spoken is beyond His power.

*Mary looks at him carefully.*

**MARY**

Why me?

**GABRIEL**

Because God has chosen you.

**MARY**

That doesn't answer the question.

*Gabriel regards her.*

*Not offended.*

**GABRIEL**

It may be the only answer you are given tonight.

*That lands.*

## **MARY SEARCHES FOR CERTAINTY**

**MARY**

You expect me to believe this?

**GABRIEL**

I expect you to decide whether you will trust the One who sent me.

**MARY**

Those aren't the same thing.

**GABRIEL**

No.

*They are not.*

*Mary studies him.*

*That answer surprises her.*

**MARY**

What happens now?

**GABRIEL**

You live the answer.

**MARY**

That's all?

**GABRIEL**

No.

*Beat.*

**GABRIEL**

Your relative Elizabeth is also expecting a child.

*Mary looks up.*

**MARY**

Elizabeth?

**GABRIEL**

Yes.

**MARY**

But she—

*Mary stops herself.*

*She knows what she was going to say.*

**GABRIEL**

What seemed impossible...

is already happening.

*Mary takes that in.*

*This is the first piece of the message she can attach to something in her world.*

**MARY**

Elizabeth.

**GABRIEL**

Go to her if you need to see what God has already begun.

## **THE COST ARRIVES**

*Mary looks toward the unfinished table.*

*The future from Scene 2 is sitting in front of her.*

*The house.*

*The table.*

*The marriage.*

*Joseph.*

*Her breathing changes slightly.*

**MARY**

What will people think?

*Gabriel does not answer immediately.*

**MARY**

My family?

The village?

*Still no false reassurance.*

**MARY**

Joseph...

*That name lands hardest.*

**MARY**

What am I supposed to tell Joseph?

**GABRIEL**

The truth.

**MARY**

And if the truth sounds impossible?

**GABRIEL**

It will still be the truth.

**MARY**

That doesn't mean he'll believe me.

**GABRIEL**

No.

*Mary looks at Gabriel.*

*That is not the answer she wanted.*

**MARY**

You don't know Joseph.

**GABRIEL**

God does.

**MARY**

He has plans.

*Her eyes move back to the table.*

**MARY**

We have plans.

A home.

A wedding.

A family.

*Beat.*

**MARY**

He thinks he knows how our life is supposed to go.

**GABRIEL**

And you?

*Mary looks at him.*

**MARY**

Until a moment ago...

so did I.

**MUSICAL TRIGGER — “CHOSEN”**

*The first musical phrase begins.*

*Not triumph.*

*Not celebration.*

*A question.*

*Gabriel does not suddenly disappear.*

*He remains present, but the focus begins transferring to Mary.*

**The song begins because she has finally understood**

*This miracle has a cost.*

“CHOSEN”

**SONG JOURNEY**

**SECTION 1 — WHY ME?**

*Mary confronts the word chosen.*

*She is not royalty.*

*Not powerful.*

*Not extraordinary by the world's standards.*

*Why would God place something this enormous in the hands of someone from Nazareth?*

*The lyrical thought should be*

*Why would being chosen feel this frightening?*

**SECTION 2 — WHAT WILL THIS COST?**

*Mary sees everything from Scene 2 in a new light*

*Joseph;*

*their wedding;  
the house;  
the table;  
her family;  
her name;  
what Nazareth will say;  
whether Joseph will stay.  
Fragments of the musical language of "My Beloved" may briefly appear underneath  
"Chosen."  
Not a full reprise.  
Just enough for the audience to feel the future that is now endangered.*

### **SECTION 3 — I CANNOT SEE THE ROAD**

*Mary begins understanding that Gabriel is not going to give her the entire future.  
She does not know  
what Joseph will do;  
how people will react;  
where this road ends;  
what obedience will cost.  
The central realization  
I do not have to see the whole road to take the next step.*

### **SECTION 4 — CHOSEN BECOMES A CHOICE**

*The word changes meaning.  
At the beginning of the song  
God chose me.  
By the end  
Will I choose to trust God?*

#### **Possible central lyrical territory**

*Chosen doesn't mean unafraid.  
and/or  
If You chose me, give me courage to choose You.  
The music grows emotionally—  
but avoid turning it into a giant power-ballad finish.*

*This should feel like Mary becoming steady, not invincible.*

### **THE MUSIC APPROACHES ITS FINAL RESOLUTION**

*Mary turns toward Gabriel.*

*The music holds.*

*Then—*

*nearly stops.*

*Silence.*

*Mary breathes.*

*She is still afraid.*

*That matters.*

#### **MARY**

I don't understand what comes next.

#### **GABRIEL**

I know.

#### **MARY**

And I'm afraid.

#### **GABRIEL**

I know.

*Beat.*

#### **MARY**

But if God has asked this of me...

*She gathers herself.*

#### **MARY**

I am the Lord's servant.

*Beat.*

#### **MARY**

Let it be with me as He has said.

*Silence.*

*No instant explosion of music.*

*No triumphant celebration.*

*Let the decision stand by itself.*

*Gabriel regards her.*

*For the first time, there may be something almost tender in his expression.*

**GABRIEL**

Do not be afraid, Mary.

*Mary takes a breath.*

**MARY**

I'm trying.

**GABRIEL**

That is enough for tonight.

**GABRIEL DEPARTS**

*The light around Gabriel begins to change.*

*Do not make his departure a magic trick simply for spectacle.*

*It can be*

*a controlled fade;*

*a shift in light;*

*Gabriel moving into darkness;*

*Mary's attention being pulled briefly elsewhere and finding him gone.*

*The divine musical texture recedes.*

*Mary is alone again.*

*Same room.*

*Same wood.*

*Same cloth.*

*Same unfinished table.*

*Nothing looks different.*

*Everything is different.*

**FINAL MOMENT**

*Mary stands quietly.*

*She touches the unfinished table.*

*A faint fragment of "My Beloved" is heard.*

*Perhaps only a few notes.*

*Mary remembers*

*"Whatever comes, I'll walk with you."*

*Her expression changes.*

*Not because she regrets saying yes.*

*Because now she understands what she has to do next.*

*She looks toward the direction Joseph left.*

**MARY**

Joseph...

**Blackout or controlled transition.**

**END SCENE 3**